



growing at a steady clip of 15 per cent. Interestingly, the developed world—which is largely responsible for most of the environmental damage caused through emissions—is willing to compensate by buying carbon credits from such clean tech companies. Such companies in India can register themselves under the government's Clean Development Mechanism (CDM) and earn certain cash for reducing carbon emissions by the tonne.

According to the United Nations, some 979 CDM projects worth \$18 billion are currently registered in the world. Of this, 62 per cent, or 611 projects, are registered in Asia, mostly in China and India. Over 747 CDM projects have been approved by the CDM National Designated Authority in India, and about 282 of these have been registered by the CDM Executive Board. The registered projects have already resulted in over 28 million tonnes of certified CO₂ emissions reduction, and directed investment in renewable energy and energy projects.

The writing is clearly on the wall: the world's natural resources are not enough to cater to the growing population. The mad scramble for alternative energy is slated to attract big money. It is estimated that about \$20 trillion will be invested in the energy sector till 2030 and most of this is likely to flow into low carbon projects coming up in India and China. No wonder companies big and small are looking to cash in on this opportunity.

The big brother of Indian business, the Tata Group, is looking at straddling different segments of clean technology. From generating solar power to producing green batteries to planting jatropha trees in barren land, the group wants to be present in every vertical. Much before green gained currency in India, the Tata Group has been building its

WHAT THE BIG BOYS ARE UP TO

MAHINDRA & MAHINDRA

PROJECT: Sustainable Mobility Solutions

AIM: The company has made sustainability its growth mantra and is pushing alternative energy and propulsion technologies like electric and hybrid vehicles, hydrogen combustion engines and bio-fuel vehicles. It is focusing on alternative fuels like CNG, which have a lower carbon footprint. These measures will address pollution-related health concerns, global warming, climate change and depletion of non-renewable, conventional fuel options. The company is collaborating with IIT Kanpur, Indian Oil Corporation's R&D centre and Lubrizol for its bio-diesel ambitions.

IMPACT: Fuel savings of up to 40 per cent for their consumers and lower emissions from vehicles.



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green businesses. The group's solar venture has become a Rs 1,100-crore company in 20 years. Established in 1989, Tata BP Solar is a joint venture between the Tata Power Company and BP Solar, one of the largest solar companies in the world. The company offers simplistic solar lanterns to complex solar photovoltaic modules for industrial use.

Tata BP Solar provides customised solar solutions for illuminating homes and streets, pumping water to fields and heating water for

residential and commercial use. It also provides reliable and cost-effective solar power to wide-ranging sectors from education and banking to healthcare and telecommunications. Says Ravi Gupta, CEO of Tata AutoComp GY Batteries: "In today's scenario, good environmental practices are also about business efficiency—it's about the best use of valuable raw materials and feeding the benefits of actions straight through to the bottomline."

Tata AutoComp has gone the whole distance by forming a joint venture with GS Yuasa International of Japan to manufacture green batteries. In Europe, 90 per cent of all batteries sold are green, which use a unique composition of calcium—calcium technology. This technology replaces traditionally used hazardous chemical elements like antimony with a harmless calcium alloy. This en-

80%

of a car will have to be recyclable under the new European Union rules by 2010.